

YouthTalk 2021

**Adolescents and Youth Empowerment Programme
Educo Bangladesh**

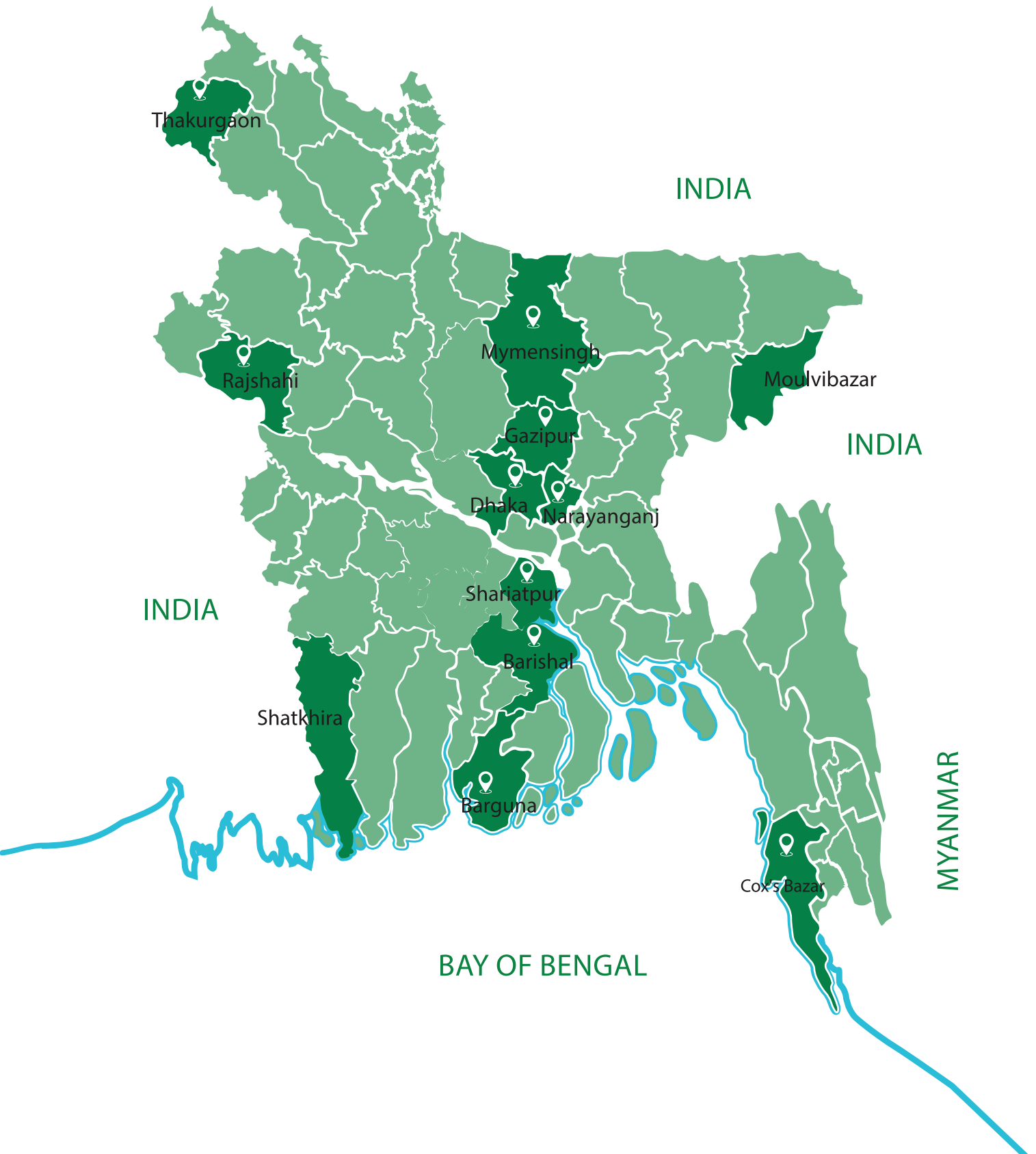
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OUR INTERVENTION AREAS

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INTERVENTION AREAS





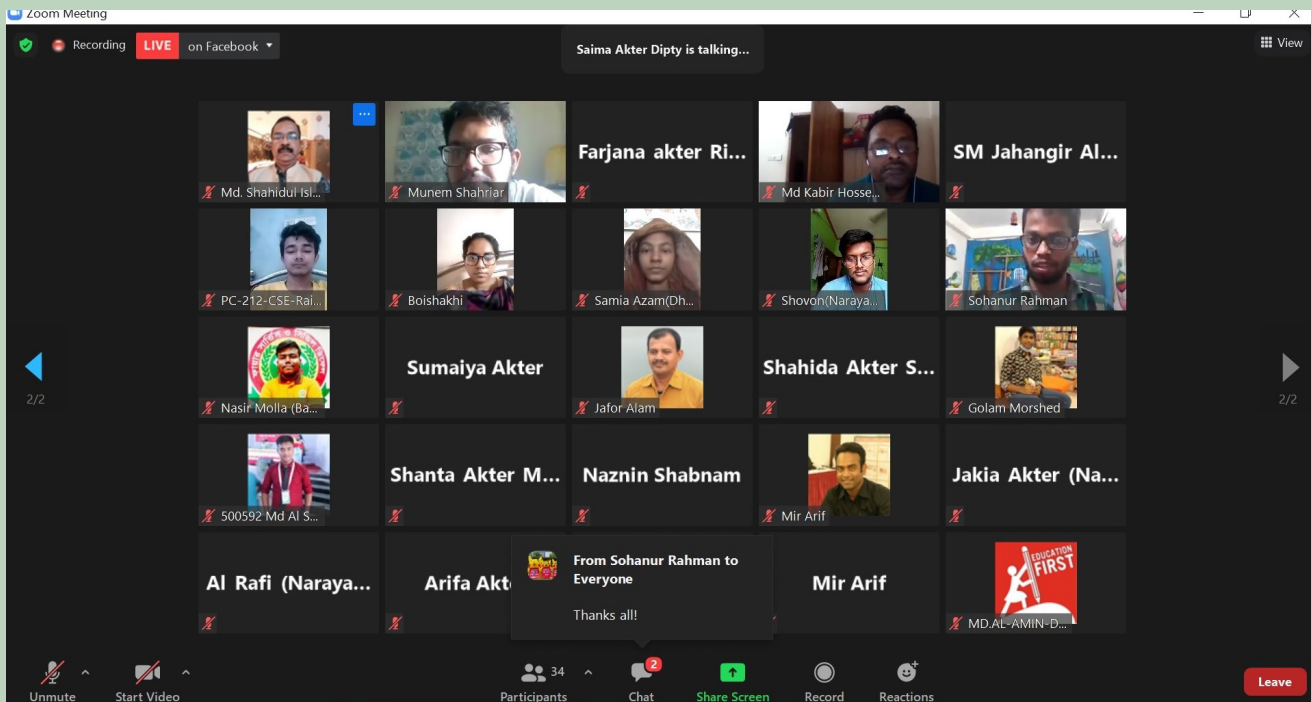
Life skill training for developing social awareness and relationship management

Educo Bangladesh Adolescents and Youth Empowerment Programme is facilitating life skills training for Adolescents and Youth (A&Y) to equip them with social and interpersonal skills required to cope with the demands of day-to-day life. Building self-confidence, encouraging critical thinking, nurturing independence, and assisting people in communicating more effectively are the prime objectives of these training. From September to November 2021, six partners, Eco-Social Development Organization (ESDO), SACHETAN, Nazrul Smriti Sangsad (NSS), Shariatpur Development Society (SDS), People's Oriented Program Implementation (POPI), and SAINT-Bangladesh, organised **12** batches of Training of the Trainers (ToTs) with targeting **298** adolescents and youth club (AYC) members. These facilitators' groups performed as peer educators and shared their learnings with their peer groups, reaching **5,480** participants at project locations in Thakurgaon, Rajshahi, Barguna, Shariatpur, Mymensingh, and Barishal. Educo Bangladesh believes that these life skills training will enable people to claim social responsibilities, develop social awareness, gain confidence in communication, teamwork, and cooperation, and constructively express and control emotions in their personal and professional lives.



Equipping hands-on learning experience

277 disadvantaged A&Y engaged in a range of training, comprising sewing machine operation, electrical installation and maintenance, plumbing, mobile phone servicing, graphic design, IT support service, IT freelancing, and integrated fish culture (fish farming in ponds and vegetable) etc. Aspiring underprivileged A&Y had a hands-on learning experience that would help them perform better in their professional lives. These training are expected to mitigate the gap between demand and supply by providing marketable skills that can be applied immediately in the workplace. Moreover, it unlocks the door for A&Y to advance into well-paid employment sectors without having a conventional degree. Furthermore, harnessing economic empowerment, particularly among girls and young women, is another approach to tackle gender-based inequalities and violence. These job-oriented trainings were facilitated by Educo Bangladesh in partnership with five partners, **NSS, SDS, ESDO, SAINT-Bangladesh, and SACHETAN**, in their respective geographical areas to establish a link with income-generating activities. Following their training, 40 A&Y (boys: 30 girls: 10) obtained BDT 189,200 as startup capital and initiated income-generating activities with their newly acquired competencies.



World Youth Skills Day 2021

More than **162** A&Y from seven districts actively participated in several events planned locally to commemorate the World Youth Skills Day 2021. Educo Bangladesh, in association with seven partners, connected these A&Y through virtual platforms on 15 July 2021. They joined and expressed their solidarity through webinars, art competitions, and an online essay writing competition. The government and other key stakeholders, including the Deputy Director, Department of Youth Development, Ministry of Youth and Sports, took part in the webinar and answered a variety of issues posed by A&Y. In addition, he vowed to continue to help the A&Y by linking them with government-sponsored vocational training options in the future. The virtual events were conducted focusing on the theme of **Reimagining Youth Skills Post-Pandemic** with a special tribute to the resilience and creativity of youth throughout the COVID-19 crisis.

All of these activities provided the opportunity for A&Y to learn about the history, significance, and objective of the World Youth Skill Day, the value of technical and vocational education and training (TVET), and the role of youth in times of social crises, such as the COVID 19 pandemic. They also exchanged information about market demands, training programmes to narrow skills gaps, and their capacity to equip themselves with skills for employment and entrepreneurship.

Developing positive attitudes through rights and governance training

Educo Bangladesh, in collaboration with seven partner organisations, facilitated participant-centered training on rights and governance. The aim was to transfer knowledge on human rights and governance and sensitise participants to their attitudes and behaviour that could violate rights inadvertently. For instance, it demonstrated different activities such as role-play, brainstorming to assist participants in becoming aware of racial, gender, or disability prejudice in their behaviours and attitudes.

As good governance and human rights are reciprocally strengthening each other, this training focuses on such interlinked issues with the tailor-made information of the communities. It focused on the reality and relevancy connected with the daily life of the learners.

As part of this endeavour, partner organisations organised ToTs to **341** AYC members. Harnessing their capacity, these AYC members demonstrated it across their peer groups and reached out to **4,291** participants from September to November 2021.



Educo Bangladesh observed 16 Days of Activism against Gender-Based Violence

Every year, the world demonstrates initiatives and gains fresh determination to stand up against gender-based violence, comprising across 16 days. This campaign commences on November 25, with the commemoration of the International Day for the Elimination of Violence against Women, and concludes with Human Rights Day, on December 10. Educo Bangladesh honours 16 days of activism against gender-based violence to convey its unity with this grave issue. This year, we joined with the local community and took the lead to further promote the goals of this campaign through various events and activities across Bangladesh in line with this year's theme: **Orange the World: End Violence against Women Now!**

We observed the 16 Days of Activism campaign with various activities throughout these days. On November 28, December 2, and 9 2021, there were sharing sessions in different offices of Educo Bangladesh to mark the campaign. After the sessions, quiz competitions were organised where all employees participated passionately. We organised a signature campaign to place individuals' promises and actions to end VAW in Bangladesh and



around the world, starting from their initiatives. Besides, a photo booth was installed at the Educo country office where everyone took photos and expressed unity to eliminate domestic and other forms of violence and create a positive environment around them.

As part of the campaign, Educo Bangladesh, in collaboration with its partners, organised debate competitions, quiz contests, art competitions, women's football matches, and human chains around different corners of Bangladesh. Besides, wall magazines, e-leaflet were widely circulated in the community to address the objective and goal of the campaign, raise awareness, and call for action to end violence against women. Approximately **1,812** adolescents and youth actively participated in different programmes to express their solidarity to advance the human rights of women.

Fostering empowerment through sports

Sports, according to Educo Bangladesh, provide for not just physical activity but also exercise empowerment. We intend to promote sports as a way to boost both boys' and girls' self-esteem, discover their latent potential, and confront harmful gender norms that persist in communities. Furthermore, Educo believes that sports may promote social development and can be used as a protection tool. It has integrated non-sports and sports activities in this regard to enhance effectiveness and achieve optimal programmes results.

As part of the effort, from September to December 2021, Educo, in association with its partners, provided training and coaching in a wide range of sports, like football, volleyball, martial arts, and has covered 149 adolescents and youth club members. Besides, celebrated sports competitions that were well-received by the community and reached **5,800** people.





Martial arts training for gaining self-confidence

Educo Bangladesh Adolescents and Youth Empowerment Programme, in association with ESDO, SACHETAN, SDS, NSS, SAINT-Bangladesh, POPI, is facilitating martial arts training in six districts of its participants to acquire self-defense techniques. The objective is to empower A&Y by enhancing self-confidence while teaching them proper time management, utilising energy, and gaining discipline and dedication. In addition, martial arts is a great stress reliever that will enable a positive impact on our participants' physical, mental, and emotional well-being. Participants have obtained skills that can be applied throughout their lifetimes. In 2021, we reached **149** A&Y, including **128** females and **21** males. Though it was a short course covering only one week to two and half months, the participants thought it was an excellent start for their next step of learning this mastery.

International Youth Day 2021

International Youth Day 2021 has been celebrated with organising a range of national and local level virtual and in-person events including dialogue sessions, theme-based essay writing competitions on 12 August. The events were conducted highlighting the theme of **Transforming Food Systems: Youth**

Innovation for Human and Planetary Health’. It created opportunities for around **200** A&Y coming from various communities to interact, share their thoughts, ask questions and learn from the relevant Govt. and other stakeholders.

Adolescents and youth are confident for mass awareness through leadership and team building training

Adolescents’ empowerment is one of the significant components of the ALOY-ALLOW project. In this project, there are 32 AYC. These clubs are functioning in Sreemangal and Kamolganj Upazila under the Moulvibazar district. In the adolescence period, they continue to grow physically, cognitively, and emotionally. Besides in this stage adolescents develop more advanced forms of reasoning and a deeper sense of self; that pursue them to establish their own identities. Moreover, societal norms and values are solidified, rejected, or transformed during this period. Developing leadership skills in adolescence can boost self-esteem and pave the way for successful adulthood.

For these reasons, Educo has facilitated leadership and team building training for 28 AYC members, that can help to learn the abilities they need to lead effectively. All participants have come from the tea garden community. This is a three day long intensive and residential training, participants are coming from Institute of Development Affairs (IDEA), Breaking the Silence (BTS), Multi-Purpose Socio-Economic Development Affairs (MSEDA) and Prochesta. Peer education approach, child protection, leadership, life skill education,



ways of communication and facilitation and other topics that have been explored throughout the training sessions. From October to December 2021, these AYC members have demonstrated their ability to exhibit their learning to their peer groups, reaching out to a total of **1,942** participants. Throughout the year, these club members enthusiastically observe various days, raise mass awareness about Disaster Risk Management, prevent violence against women, exercise child protection, birth registration, hand washing process, and other things.

Women friendship football matches

Under the Educo Bangladesh Adolescents and Youth Empowerment Programme, partners organisations, ESDO and SACHETAN, hosted two friendship football matches in Thakurgaon and Rajshahi, respectively, at Ranisankail and Godagari Upazilas, on 9 December 2021. The respective Chairman and Vice-Chairman, Upazila Parishad, Upazila Youth Development Officer, Ranisankail and Godagari Upazila, as well as a huge number of community people, were there to observe the matches. To boost the players' motivation, a debate and prize-giving ceremony were held after the matches. Around **800** community people, including parents, UP members, A&Y watched the games.





Adolescents led awareness campaign on combatting sexual and gender-based violence in Rohingya and host community of Cox's Bazar

A total of seven awareness campaigns led by A&Y, on "Ending Violence Against Children (EVAC)" were organised at camp 8E, camp 17, camp 8W and host community with the support of Educo Bangladesh in 2021. The campaign was mainly focused on elimination of sexual and gender-based violence, and it was organised to raise mass awareness and to commemorate the "16 Days of Activism Against Gender-Based Violence" as well as "International Day for People with Disabilities". A total of **1,535** adolescents and youth, teachers, parents, government officials from International and national NGOs including Govt. representatives took part in the campaign. The day-long campaign included an art competition, an award ceremony, a hand painting activity, sports and entertainment programmes, as well as gifts and prizes for the children and by taking an oath the children showed their solidarity to fight against violence.

Tea garden adolescents and youth are shifting away from traditional occupation

From the inception of the ALOY-ALLOW project, 24 AYC members have undergone intensive 45-day long residential training on “Tailoring and Dress Making” and “Mobile Phone Servicing”. All of the Participants have come from the tea garden community of Sreemangal and Kamolganj upazila. Caritas Sreemangal, in association with Educo Bangladesh, facilitated the training. Participants from IDEA, BTS, MSED and Prochesta are participated in the training programme. The main goal of this training is to connect with other income-generating sources and transform the tea garden community's conventional profession. Besides, the trainees are eager to contribute not only their families but also for their clubs. At first, all participants have prepared their business plan. To initiate their business, in total BDT 50,000 has been provided to the trainees in 2021 including their contribution. Upazila Youth Development officer is engaged in the trade selection process and follow up the progress of trainees. All are now active in the local market and meeting the local product demand. They are confident in their ability to build their business and generate chances for others. Moreover, they can inspire other A&Y in their communities to choose their own business.



Capacity building training to empower the adolescents and youth club members

Age and gender specific child protection, prevention of gender discrimination, and gender-based violence module had been shared and taught to 1,300 adolescent boys and girls of the adolescents club at camp 8E, camp 8W and camp 17 in 2021. The training was led by Educo Bangladesh, collaboration with Jagorani Chakra Foundation (JCF) and Samaj Kalyan o Unnayan Shangstha (SKUS), where the trained child protection facilitators and community mobilisers conducted the sessions. During the training, adolescent boys and girls discussed their experiences with protection concerns and how they addressed them. Boys and girls received separate training with the purpose of adhering to local culture and norms. Adolescents gained new knowledge about child protection and GBV issues as a result of the training. Barriers that prevent identification of survivors and demand for case management services and make known referral mechanisms to such services have been addressed in the training. In every session the facilitator discussed about the existing referral pathway of the camp to seek services when required.





Ecologically Friendly Impact-Invested Enterprises for Adolescents and Youth Club

In the Shariatpur district, the Adolescents and Youth Club (AYC) members participated in a 10-day hands-on training on integrated fish culture. Shariatpur Development Society, in collaboration with Educo Bangladesh, facilitated this training. A total of 35 aspiring adolescents participated in the training for social entrepreneurship ventures. Among them, 10 members of the AYC expressed their interest in forming a joint venture to begin environmentally sustainable integrated fish farming. With SDS's technical assistance, they leased one waste pond and began fish farming and vegetable cultivation along the ponds' banks. They are applying organic farming in order to reduce pollution. In November 2021, they have started their farm, sharing their expertise and knowledge of organic farming with the community, and helping the community for raising awareness on climate change adaptation and ecological transition.



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